



NEWS78 *June 2016*

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FLEA NEWS is a biannual newsletter about fleas (Siphonaptera). Recipients are urged to check any citations given here before including them in publications. Many of our sources are abstracting journals and current literature sources such as National Agricultural Library (NAL) Agricola, and National Library of Medicine (NLM) Medline, and citations have not necessarily been checked for accuracy or consistent formatting.

Recipients are urged to contribute items of interest to the profession for inclusion herein, including: Flea research citations from journals that are not indexed in Agricola or Medline databases, Announcements and Requests for material, Contact information for a Directory of Siphonapterists (name, mailing address, email address, and areas of interest - Systematics, Ecology, Control, etc.), Abstracts of research planned or in progress, Book and Literature Reviews, Biography, Hypotheses, and Anecdotes. Send to:

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Editorial

Dear *Flea News* Reader,

In a series of papers, Medvedev (see Featured Research) analyzes the features of the flea head and thorax for phylogenetic significance. What is the ecological significance, if any, of these features? Though features such as ctenidia (combs) have been researched as to ecological function, siphonapterists still have a lot of research necessary to address how various morphological traits contribute to a particular species' ability to thrive in its niche.

The origin of fleas, and particular the nature of "giant flea" fossils, continues to be debated in papers by Dittmar et al. and Gao et al. (see Featured Research). They present contrasting hypotheses, but agree on many points.

When did fleas originate? Fleas originated in the Cretaceous, or perhaps even earlier in the Jurassic to the Triassic-Jurassic boundary (Medvedev 2014. The Palaearctic centers of taxonomic diversity of fleas (Siphonaptera). *Entomological Review* 94.3: 345-358). Lice and parasitic Acari appear in the Cretaceous, too.

Where did fleas originate? The southern continents fragmenting from Gondwanaland seems likely based on diversity distribution. For example, the most ancient group of extant fleas (Pulicomorphs) is diverse in Africa (Afro-tropical) and South America (Neotropical). However, in seeming contradiction, temperate diversity of fleas is greater than tropical diversity.

What sort of habitat? It seems likely that ectothermic vertebrate nests fostered the first fleas.

What sort of biome? It seems likely that flea originated in a cold biome, temperate, alpine, or polar, because snow scorpionflies (see next question) live in such areas. If true, this may help explain why the greater diversity of fleas in temperate areas.

What were the ancestors of fleas? Boreidae, the snow scorpionflies (Mecoptera), are generally agreed

to be nearest relatives to fleas. This relationship presents a puzzle for the hypothesis that fleas originated in the southern hemisphere; although scorpionflies are found globally, Boreidae are found only in the northern hemisphere.

What sort of hosts? Though therians (placental and marsupial mammals) were in existence as early as the Jurassic, there were a large number of non-therian vertebrates, too. These were egg-laying, furred synapsids (non-therian therapsids), and occupied a variety of niches, not only insectivore, but also herbivore, carnivore, flying squirrel-like, aquatic, etc. Therapsids first appear in the Triassic (251-201 mya), but fur in coprolites appears even earlier, the Permian (298-252 mya). These non-therian therapsids are all extinct, except for the monotremes (platypus). Dinosaurs and pterosaurs are possible hosts also.

What is the nature of the giant fleas? Here, the papers disagree but there are several hypotheses. The following questions require investigation:

1. Are the giant fleas ectoparasites?
2. Are they to be grouped as Siphonaptera?
3. Are they direct ancestors of Siphonaptera?
4. Are they a branch of a, as yet unnamed, clade of proto-siphonaptera?
5. Are they Mecopteroids, or another insect stock?

Further examination of the fossils may answer these questions.

Taking a broad view of flea evolution, we consider that terrestrial vertebrates (amniotes) have two major groups: the synapsids and the diapsids (the third group, the anapsids, is today represented only by turtles). The 3 groups are distinguished by numbers of fenestra (holes) in the skull. Both groups originate about the same time, with the synapsid having a tendency for endothermy, usually assisted with fur, and the diapsid tending to be ectothermic, at least until much later, when feathers and large body masses of dinosaurs, and later birds, allowed endothermy.

One aspect that biologists need to consider for the origin of fleas is the importance of endothermy (hot-bloodedness) in hosts for flea development. Undoubtedly, the growth and reproductive rates of fleas and lice are increased due to the elevated temperatures of their hot-blooded hosts (Wharton, D.A. 1999. Parasites and low temperatures. *Parasitology* 119(S1): S7-S17). In a sense, fleas and lice are "hot-blooded by association". If Siphonaptera developed on furred, non-therian synapsids, and lice developed on feathered anapsids, then these two different insulations explain much about the differences between fleas and lice.

Complicating any understanding of flea origins is the enormous number of now-extinct, non-therian synapsids (described above) and feathered dinosaurs that lived in the Cretaceous and Jurassic. Many synapsids inhabited nests, had fur, and seemed endothermic. These synapsids could have played host to fleas, should such fleas have existed, before Theria ever appeared.

We can hypothesize the origin of fleas. The first fleas' habitat may have been the south polar forest in the Cretaceous and Jurassic periods, a biome not existing on Earth today. Elevated carbon dioxide, long summer days, moderate summers, and freezing winters fostered luxuriant forests with

dinosaurs and non-therian synapsids. In addition, there were periodic freezing episodes during the Cretaceous.

A likely candidate host for the first fleas would be the tritylodontids, or similar, which were non-therian synapsid herbivores. They were widely distributed and abundant throughout the globe, including the south polar forests. Importantly for fleas, tritylodontids were furred, ectothermic, and burrowing. In addition, tritylodontids hibernated during the long winter of the polar regions.

Boreids are known to live in mammal dens and suck fluids even today. It seems likely that moss-inhabiting boreids would have been attracted to the warmth and fluids of hibernating synapsids, and been able to feed on them.

Thanks to everyone who contributed items, especially the "Essai de bibliographie des Siphonaptères de 1943 à 1972" of J.-C. Beaucournu, in this Flea News, that extends our bibliography on fleas until before Flea News began in 1974.

Yours in fleas,
R.L. Bossard
Editor, *Flea News*

Announcements

Total Number, and an Updated Listing, of Flea Species of the World
(continued from the preceding Flea News)

Following up with the interest in a listing of flea species, there is now a preliminary list of all flea species in the world on the Flea News network at the Entomological Society of America website. See the list of pages on the Flea News homepage.

Please send me any species that are missing to add them to the list.

R.L. Bossard
Editor, *Flea News*

New Dissertations

Student: Ana Cecilia Gozzi.

Title: Estudios parasitológicos de la ardilla de vientre rojo introducida en Argentina y su relación con la comunidad de mamíferos del ambiente receptor.

[Parasitological studies of red-bellied squirrel introduced in Argentina and their relationship with the community of mammals in the receiving environment.]

Degree: Doctorado en Ciencias Aplicadas

Date: 10 November 2015

Director: M. L. Guicho. Codirector: M. Lareschi
 School: Universidad Nacional de Luján

Gozzi AC, ML Guichón, VV Benitez y M Lareschi (2013) Arthropod parasites of the red-bellied squirrel *Callosciurus erythraeus* (Rodentia: Sciuridae) introduced into Argentina. Medical and Veterinary Entomology 27:203-208 [DOI: 10.1111/j.1365-2915.2012.01052.x].

The introduction of an exotic species usually modifies parasite–host dynamics by the import of new parasites or the exotic species’ acquiral [sic, acquisition] of local parasites. The loss of parasites may determine the outcome of an invasion if the introduced species is liberated from co-evolved parasites in its range of invasion. In addition, an introduced species may pose sanitary risks to humans and other mammals if it serves as a reservoir of pathogens or carries arthropod vectors. The red-bellied squirrel, *Callosciurus erythraeus* (Pallas) (Rodentia: Sciuridae), was introduced into Argentina in 1970, since when several foci of invasion have been closely associated with humans. Investigation of the parasitological fauna of *C. erythraeus* in Argentina will generate new information about novel parasite–host dynamics and may provide new insight into the reasons for the successful invasion of this species. The objective of this study was to describe the arthropod parasites of *C. erythraeus* in Argentina in comparison with previous studies of parasites of this species in its native habitat and in the ranges of its invasion. Occasional host–parasite associations with local arthropod parasites not previously described for *C. erythraeus* are reported; these include the mites *Androlaelaps fahrenheitsi* (Ewing) (Mesostigmata: Laelapidae) and *Ornithonyssus cf. bacoti* (Mesostigmata: Macronyssidae), the flea *Polygenis (Polygenis) rimatus* Jordan (Siphonaptera: Rhopalopsyllidae) and the botfly *Cuterebra* [sp.] Clark (Diptera: Oestridae: Cuterebrinae). *Cheyletus* sp. mites (Trombidiformes: Cheyletidae) were also found. The low prevalence and mean intensity of ectoparasite species may influence invasion dynamics.

El objetivo general del trabajo fue describir la fauna parasitaria (macro- y micro- parásitos) y el potencial zoonótico de la ardilla de vientre rojo (*Callosciurus erythraeus*) como modelo de especie de micromamífero introducido en Argentina, determinar si las asociaciones parásitos-ardilla se establecen en función de la comunidad de mamíferos no voladores que utilizan el mismo ambiente, relacionando lo encontrado con el éxito de invasión.

[The overall objective was to describe the parasitic fauna (macro- and micro-parasites) and the zoonotic potential of red-bellied squirrel (*Callosciurus erythraeus*) as model species of micromammals introduced into Argentina, and determine whether associations of parasites-squirrel are based on the community of non-flying mammals that use the same environment, relating to the success of invasion.]

Student: Indrè Lipatova
 Title: THE DIVERSITY OF FLEA (SIPHONAPTERA) SPECIES AND FLEA-BORNE PATHOGENS
 Scientific supervisor: Prof. Dr. Algimantas Paulauskas
 Degree: Dissertation
 School: Vytautas Magnus University, Lithuania
 Date: 21 December 2015

Fleas (Insecta: Siphonaptera) are common ectoparasites of mammals and birds in different habitats throughout the world. The Lithuanian flea fauna has not been exhaustively researched, and the real situation is not known as compared with other world regions. The flea species described so far in Lithuania do not include all Siphonaptera fauna that is possible in Lithuania. The aim of the dissertation was to investigate the diversity of flea species on different hosts and habitats and flea-borne pathogens. The obtained results of the conducted research allowed to assess the diversity of flea species in Lithuania and to supplement the list of Lithuanian Siphonaptera. The results of the dissertation are as follows: seven flea species new for the Lithuanian flea fauna were determined: *Hystrichopsylla orientalis*, *Ceratophyllus gallinae*, *C. affinis*, *C. rusticus*, *C. hirundinis*, *C. farreni*, *C. styx*. For the first time in Lithuania, *Bartonella grahamii*, *B. taylorii*, *B. rochalimae*, and *Rickettsia helvetica* pathogens were identified in fleas of small mammals.

Student: MONTEIRO, Maria Fernanda Melo

Title: Detecção de *Rickettsia* spp. em *Rhipicephalus sanguineus* (Latreille, 1806) (Acari: Ixodidae) e *Ctenocephalides felis felis* (Bouché, 1835) (Siphonaptera: Pulicidae).

Date: 2016

Degree Name: Dissertação

Department: Programa de Pós-Graduação em Biociência Animal

School: Universidade Federal Rural de Pernambuco, Recife, Brasil.

Rickettsial diseases are zoonotic infections caused by gram-negative bacteria of the family Rickettsiaceae which are transmitted by several ectoparasites such as ticks belonging to the genus *Amblyomma*, however, the species *Rhipicephalus sanguineus sensu lato* (s.l.) and *Ctenocephalides felis felis* have been reported as potential vectors. The aim of this study was to detect *Rickettsia* spp. DNA in *R. sanguineus* s.l. and *C. felis felis* through molecular examination (Polymerase Chain Reaction PCR). A total of 728 ectoparasites were collected of 155 dogs from the states of Pernambuco (municipalities of Recife and Bezerros) and Alagoas (municipalities of Viçosa and Arapiraca) were used in this study. All specimens were morphologically identified (*R. sanguineus* s.l. and *C. felis felis*), separated in pools (n = 3) and analyzed molecularly through PCR. Out of the 136 pools of *R. sanguineus* s.l. analyzed, 20.58% (28/136) and 80 pools of *C. felis felis* analyzed 31.20% (39/80) it was observed amplification fragment of 401 bp compatible with *Rickettsia* spp. In relation to the positivity of ectoparasites in the municipalities studied, it was observed that *R. sanguineus* s.l. was positive in the Metropolitan Area of Recife (20.49%) and Bezerros (22.22%), however in the state of Alagoas was not observed the positivity for Viçosa municipality, but, Arapiraca got 25% positive. With regard to *C. felis felis* it was observed that in Pernambuco 54.54% of samples were positive being derived from Metropolitan Area of Recife, while Bezerros municipality was not observed amplification of the fragment compatible with *Rickettsia* spp. In Alagoas, it was observed 12.50% of positivity for Arapiraca and 50.00% for Viçosa. This study reports, for the first time, the detection of *Rickettsia* spp. in *R. sanguineus* s.l. parasitizing dogs from the state of Pernambuco and *R. sanguineus* s.l. and *C. felis felis* parasitizing dogs from the state of Alagoas. Although there are no reports of Brazilian Spotted Fever (BSF) in the areas studied, the presence of infected ticks and fleas suggests the circulation of the pathogen between vertebrate hosts and vectors.

Student: Strong, Adam Clinton

Title: Ecological and biological stress effects on the ground squirrel flea, *Oropsylla montana* (Siphonaptera: Ceratophyllidae)

Date: 2015

School: Entomology, Washington State University

Background: Transmission and persistence of *Yersinia pestis*, the agent of plague, depend on properties of the pathogen, fleas, vertebrate hosts, and environment. In North America the ground squirrel flea, *Oropsylla montana*, is the primary vector of *Y. pestis*. Little is known about the interactions between *O. montana* and the pathogen or larval resource requirements. To better understand the role of abiotic conditions, flea demographics, and larval competition in plague dynamics, I determined flea survival, fecundity and pathogen load under different conditions of temperature, relative humidity, gender, mating condition, and food resources.

Methods: To test abiotic effects on *Y. pestis* infectivity, *O. montana* fleas were reared under different temperatures, then infected with *Y. pestis* followed by bacterial load quantification. Further abiotic tests exposed infected fleas to high or low variation abiotic regimes for 5 weeks; mortality, fecundity, and bacterial loads determined at the conclusion. To test adult flea demographic effects, sexually dimorphic (un)mated adults were infected followed by bacterial load and mortality calculation. Finally, flea larvae were subjected to varying degrees of density and food-resource dilutions to evaluate effects on metamorphosis and adult size.

Results: Fleas experiencing stress from abiotic changes had higher bacterial loads and laid fewer eggs than fleas under less extreme or dynamic conditions. Overall, survival was greater at lower temperatures. A higher proportion of unmated females survived than other gender and mating treatments and bacterial loads were higher in females but did not differ between like sexes in either unmated or mated fleas. No larval density or resource dilutions tested affected the number of F1 generation adults, but the lowest food dilutions resulted in smaller adult females.

Conclusions: Fleas under stress from abiotic changes had increased *Y. pestis* growth, reduced fecundity, and unpredictable mortality. This implies that flea and pathogen microclimate variation has a significant effect upon *Y. pestis* prevalence in the environment, possibly increasing plague risk due to global climate change. Also, female fleas have a greater role in plague transmission due to increased bacterial development. Finally, food resource requirements of *O. montana* larvae are extremely minimal and likely have little effect upon flea population size.

Meetings

2016 International Conference on Diseases in Nature Communicable to Man (INCDNCM) will be held at the University of Guelph on August 7-9, 2016.

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The 60th Livestock Insect Workers' Conference was held June 26-29, 2016 in Oklahoma City, hosted by Dr. Justin Talley of Oklahoma State University (Stillwater). Bill Donahue and Nancy Hinkle presented papers on Fred W. Knapp who conducted research on flea control.

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"Impacts of Insecticide Plague Treatment on Deer Mice and Fleas in Prairie Dog Colonies"

Dombro, Lenora

Auburn University

22nd Annual Conference of the Wildlife Society

RBC Convention Centre, Winnipeg, Manitoba, 17-21 Oct 2015

Essai de bibliographie des Siphonaptères de 1943 à 1972

J.-C. Beaucournu

Laboratoire de Parasitologie médicale, Faculté de Médecine de Rennes, 2 Avenue du Professeur Léon Bernard, F. 35043 Rennes cedex et Institut de Parasitologie de l'Ouest, même adresse.

En 1946, Costa-Lima et Hathaway publiaient (in *Monografias do Instituto Oswaldo Cruz*, n° 4) une remarquable compilation des travaux sur les Siphonaptères, et sur la peste bien évidemment, « *Pulgas, Bibliografia, Catálogo e Hospedadores* » : les articles ou ouvrages cités commençaient en 1546 avec Moschetti « *De pulice* » et s'achevaient en 1944 sur un article de Prince « *Descriptions of three new species of Thrassis Jordan....* ». Toutefois ces auteurs notaient que de 1942 à 1944, leur liste devaient avoir des lacunes, ce qui s'expliquait par les événements liés à la 2ème guerre mondiale. En 1974, F.G.A.M. Smit, Curateur de la collection Rothschild de puces au British Museum (Natural History), crée « *Flea News* », un peu dans l'esprit de « *Mosquito News* » dédié aux nématocères hématophages. Dans cette publication ronéotypée l'auteur va donner non seulement des listes bibliographiques (la première concerne l'année 1973, année que nous avons reprise pour assurer la continuité), mais aussi divers renseignements sur les méthodes à utiliser pour l'étude des puces et en particulier comment les dessiner, sur les erreurs à éviter dans les mensurations ou sur le nombre d'auteurs admissible dans la description d'une nouvelle espèce, sur les entomologistes intéressés par cet Ordre, sur les congrès... Bref, cette « revue », paraissant deux à trois fois par an, fut très appréciée. Lorsque Frans Smit, mis à la retraite, fut contraint d'abandonner cette publication en 1980, 20 numéros étaient parus. La poursuite en fut immédiatement assurée par R.E. Lewis (Department of Entomology, Iowa State University) du n° 21 au n° 60 à raison de deux parutions par an, jusqu'en 2000. En 2007, le flambeau est repris par R. Bossard et N.C. Hinckle (bossardtech@gmail.com ; NHinkle@uga.edu) et ce jusqu'à nos jours (2016) où le fascicule 77 de décembre 2015 vient de paraître.

Il ressort de ce survol, qu'une lacune apparaît dans cette recherche bibliographique de 1944, ou même de 1942, à 1972 inclus. C'est cela que nous allons tenter de combler au moins pour les travaux rédigés en caractères romains. Les articles russes, chinois, japonais... ne seront cités que si le titre, au moins, est traduit en anglais, en français ou en allemand. Eventuellement, des travaux antérieurs à 1942 seront cités s'ils furent oubliés par Costa-Lima & Hathaway, mais montrent un certain intérêt. Notre

travail ne veut, et ne peut, être exhaustif, car il ne s'agit que des articles présents dans notre bibliothèque, mais nous pensons qu'il est utile étant donné, en particulier, la période couverte pendant, et au lendemain de la 2ème guerre mondiale. Par contre, nous n'avons pas retenu les références datant d'avant 1900 omises par Costa-Lima et Hathaway (*op. cit.*).

Nous avons été aidé pour la signification de l'abrégé de certaines publications, pas toutes malheureusement, par les « *serial publications* » du tome I de « *Bibliography of Ticks and tickborne diseases* » de Harry Hoogstraal (1970 : *Bibliography of Ticks and tickborne diseases, from Homer (about 800 B.C.) to 31 december 1969*. United States Naval Medical Research Unit Number Three (Namru-3), Cairo, Egypt, U.A.R.).

[(Ed. transl.) In 1946, Costa-Lima and Hathaway published (in *Monografias do Instituto Oswaldo Cruz*, No. 4) a remarkable compilation of work on Siphonaptera, and plague of course, "*Pulgas, Bibliografia, Catalogue e Hospedadores*" items or cited works that began in 1546 with Moschetti "*De pulice*" and ending in 1944 with an article by Prince "*Descriptions of three new species of Thrassis Jordan*". However, these authors noted that from 1942 to 1944, the list had gaps which were due to events related to the 2nd World War. In 1974, F.G.A.M. Smit, Curator of the Rothschild collection of fleas in the British Museum (Natural History), created "*Flea News*", somewhat in the spirit of "*Mosquito News*" dedicated to bloodsucking Nematocera. In this mimeographed publication the author will give not only bibliographic lists (the first concerns the year 1973, which we have taken to ensure continuity), but also information on various methods for studying fleas especially on mistakes to avoid in measurements or on the number of eligible writers in the description of a new species, entomologists interested in this Order, meetings ... in short, this "review", appearing two to three times a year, was highly appreciated. When Frans Smit retired and was constrained to abandon this publication in 1980, 20 issues were published. The pursuit was immediately assumed by RE Lewis (Department of Entomology, Iowa State University) from No. 21 to No. 60 with two issues per year, until 2000. In 2007, the torch was taken by R. Bossard and N. C. Hinkle (bossardtech@gmail.com; NHinkle@uga.edu) until today (2016) where the specification of 77 December 2015 has been published.

It is clear from this overview, a gap appears in this literature search from 1944 or even 1942 to 1972 inclusive. That is why we will try to fill in at least for works written in Roman characters. Russian articles, Chinese, Japanese ... will be mentioned only if the title, at least, is translated into English, French or German. Eventually, previous work and 1942 will be cited if they were forgotten by Costa-Lima & Hathaway, but maintain a certain interest. Our job is not, and cannot be, exhaustive because it is only a matter of the articles in our library, but we believe it is useful, in particular, for the period during and after World War II. To the contrary, we have not included references dating back to 1900 omitted by Costa-Lima and Hathaway (*op. cit.*).

We were aided to the significance of the abstract of certain publications, not all unfortunately, by "*serial publications*" of Volume I of "*Bibliography of Ticks and Tickborne Diseases*" of Harry Hoogstraal (1970 : *Bibliography of Ticks and Tickborne Diseases, from Homer (about 800 B.C.) to 31 December 1969*. United States Naval Medical Research Unit Number Three (NAMRU-3), Cairo, Egypt, U.A.R.).]

1900

Blanchard R. Notes historiques sur la Peste. *Archives de Parasitologie*, **3** : 589-643.

Galli-Valerio B. Sur les puces d' « *Arvicola nivalis* ». *Archives de Parasitologie*, **3** : 96-101.

1903

Blanchard R. Un piège à Puces. *Archives de Parasitologie*, **7** : 169.

1905

Galli-Valerio B. Einige Parasiten von *Arvicola nivalis*. *Zool. Anzeig.*, **28** : 519-522.

1906

Iches L. Un nouveau piège à Puces. *Archives de Parasitologie*, **10** : 478.

1907

Advisory Committee, XI. The diagnosis of natural rat plague. *Journal of Hygiene*, **7** : 324-476 (cité, mais avec des erreurs, par Costa-Lima & Hathaway).

1908

Billet A. La Peste en Algérie en 1907. Recherches particulières sur les rats, leurs ectoparasites et leurs rapports avec l'épidémie, dans le département de Constantine. *Bulletin de la Société de pathologie exotique*, **1** : 111-117.

Broquet Ch. Procédé de conservation des ganglions pesteux pour le diagnostic. *Bulletin de la Société de pathologie exotique*, **1** : 547.

Conseil E. Cinq cas de peste observés à Tunis. *Bulletin de la Société de pathologie exotique*, **1** : 167-169.

Niclot La peste à Oran en 1907. Ectoparasites des rats pesteux et multiplication du bacille de Yersin dans leur tube digestif. *Bulletin de la Société de pathologie exotique*, **1** : 367-369.

Nicolle C. La peste en Tunisie pendant l'année 1907. *Bulletin de la Société de pathologie exotique*, **1** : 165-167.

1909

Castel & Lafont Cas de Peste traités par le sérum antipesteux en injections intraveineuses massives. *Bulletin de la Société de pathologie exotique*, **2** : 195-199.

Cobelli R. Gli Aphaniptera di Trentino. *Verhandlungen der K.K. Zoologisch-botanischen Gesellschaft in Wien*, **59** : 6.

Conseil E. Recherches sur la peste en Tunisie. *Bulletin de la Société de pathologie exotique*, **2** : 323-327.

Fox C. A parasite found on a Flea. *Proceedings of the Entomological Section, Academy of Natural Sciences, Philadelphia*, p. 216.

1910

Meirelles Z. Epidémiologie de la Variole. *Bulletin de la Société de pathologie exotique*, **3** : 98-104.

Mitzmain M.B. A parasitic and a predatory enemy of the flea. *Public Health Report*, Washington, **25** : 393-397.

1911

Broquet Le masque dans la peste – présentation d'un modèle de masque antipesteux. *Bulletin de la*

Société de pathologie exotique, **4** : 636-645.

Laforce F.M., Acharya I.L., Stoff G., Brachman P.S., Kaufma A.F., Clapp R.F. & Shah N.K. Clinical and Epidemiological Observations on an outbreak of Plague in Nepal. *Bulletin de l'O.M.S.*, **45** : 693-706.

Manaud A. Prophylaxie de la peste par la désinfection « pulicide ». *Bulletin de la Société de pathologie exotique*, **4** : 224-227.

Manaud A. La Peste au Siam. *Bulletin de la Société de pathologie exotique*, **4** : 351-358.

Manaud A. Prophylaxie de la peste bubonique au Siam. *Bulletin de la Société de pathologie exotique*, **4** : 492-497.

Martin C.J. & Rowland S. Observations on Rat Plague in East Suffolk, November and December, 1910. *Great Britain Local Government Board Fortieth Annual Report*, pp. 41-55.

Weiss A. Addition au Catalogue des Arthropodes piqueurs de Djerba. *Archives de l'Institut Pasteur de Tunis*, pp. 268-274.

1912

Krausse A.H. Sardische Flöhe. *Archiv. für Naturgeschichte*, **78** : 187.

Sergent Ed., Sergent Et., Lhéritier A. & Lemaire G. Transmission de *Leishmania* de chien à chien par piqûres de *Pulex serraticeps*. *Bulletin de la Société de pathologie exotique*, **5** : 595-597.

1913

Waterston J. Variation in the genal comb of *Typhloceras poppei*, Wagn.. *Entomologist's Monthly Magazine*, **49** : 18.

Weiss A. Troisième addition (fin) au Catalogue des Arthropodes piqueurs de Djerba. *Archives de l'Institut Pasteur de Tunis*, p. 118.

1914

Laveran A. & Franchini G. Infections de Mammifères par des flagellés d'invertébrés. *Bulletin de la Société de pathologie exotique*, **7** : 605-612.

1915

Kerandel J. Insectivore réservoir de virus de la peste au Cambodge. *Bulletin de la Société de pathologie exotique*, **8** : 54-57.

Laveran A. & Franchini G. Au sujet d'un *Herpetomonas* de *Ctenopsylla musculi* et de sa culture. *Bulletin de la Société de pathologie exotique*, **8** : 266-270.

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Zatzarina G.V. *Sayanian Alacurt (Dorcadia dorcadia Roth.; Aphaniptera: Vermipsyllidae) – Pest of the velvet tip Siberian red deer-breeding*. Moscow Lomonosov State University, Faculty of Biology and Soil Science, Biodeterioration Research Laboratory, Moscow, 1972, 107 pp. (en russe, seul le titre est en anglais).

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Featured Research

New Fleas 2016

Beaucournu J.-C., Moreno L. & Gonzalez- Acuna D., 2016. Le genre *Dasyipsyllus* Baker 1905 (Siphonaptera : Ceratophyllidae): description d'une espèce nouvelle et essai de mise au point sur ce genre. *Annales de la Société entomologique de France*, 52: 1-7.
<http://dx.doi.org/10.1080/00379271.2016.1144484>

Dasyipsyllus picaflori n. sp.. is described from fleas taken from the nest of *Oreotrochilus leucopleurus* Gould 1847, a Trochilidae, in Chile. This is the second species of flea described from

hummingbirds. Taxonomy, distribution, ecology and specificity of species and subspecies included in the genus *Dasypsyllus* are studied.

<http://zoobank.org/urn:lsid:zoobank.org:pub:9D19F26E-6FB8-434D-AFB7-D95F45589B10>

Chaber A.-L., Lignereux L., Cardenas E., Melville H. & Beaucournu J.-C., 2016. Note sur les Siphonaptères de l'Émirat de Ras Al Khaimah: description de *Nosopsyllus (Gerbillophilus) jabeljaisensis* n. sp. (Siphonaptera, Ceratophyllidae, Ceratophyllinae). Annales de la Société entomologique de France (N.S.), 2016, 52 : 1-5.

<http://dx.doi.org/10.1080/00379271.2016.1174621>

David K. Mardon, Lance A. Durden. *Musserellus* gen. nov., and Five New Species of Fleas (Siphonaptera: Stivaliidae) From Murid Rodents in Sulawesi and West Papua, Indonesia. Journal of Medical Entomology, 2016; tjw012
DOI: 10.1093/jme/tjw012

A new stivaliid flea genus, *Musserellus*, and five new species are described. The new genus is compared with its closest morphological relatives, the genera *Rectidigitus* Holland and *Metastivalius* Holland. *Musserellus vanpeeneni* sp. nov., *Musserellus wattsi* sp. nov., *Musserellus whitei* sp. nov., and *Musserellus marshalli* sp. nov. are described from endemic murid rodents in Sulawesi, Indonesia, while *Musserellus dunneti* sp. nov. is described from *Rattus rattus* in West Papua, Indonesia. Host associations and the biogeographical relevance of the faunal connection between Sulawesi and New Guinea shown by *Musserellus* are briefly discussed.

[*Musserellus dunneti*, *Musserellus marshalli*, *Musserellus vanpeeneni*, *Musserellus wattsi*, and *Musserellus whitei*]

Entomological Society of America. "New genus and five new flea species discovered in Indonesia." ScienceDaily. ScienceDaily, 14 April 2016.

<www.sciencedaily.com/releases/2016/04/160414081522.htm>

Hosts and Distribution

Howell, L., Jelden, K., Rácz, S. E., Gardner, S. L., & Gettinger, D. D. (2016). Arthropods infesting small mammals (Insectivora and Rodentia) near Cedar Point Biological Station in southwestern Nebraska. *Insecta Mundi* 0478: 1–16.

<http://digitalcommons.unl.edu/insectamundi/954/>

Cedar Point Biological Station (CPBS) is located in the mixed grass prairie of the central Great Plains, at the transition between the subregions known as the “tall grass” and “short grass” prairies. Adding to the habitat diversity, there are wetlands and riparian habitats associated with the North Platte River and the edge of the Sandhills region of north central Nebraska. This concurrence of habitats supports a diverse small mammal community. The purpose of this paper is to assemble all published information on ectoparasites associated with small mammals (Insectivora, Rodentia) of southwestern Nebraska, and to report the results of an intensive survey carried out by students of the Parasitology field course during two summers at CPBS. In 2012 and 2013, 27 species of mammal-associated arthropods were collected, including five species of sucking lice (Anoplura), a chewing louse (Ischnocera), six species of fleas (Siphonaptera), thirteen species of mesostigmatic mites (Laelapidae,

Macronyssidae, Macrochelidae), and two species of metastigmatic ticks (Ixodidae). These specimens were brushed from the pelage of 11 species of small mammals that were captured in a variety of habitats around CPBS. The arthropod list includes 17 new records for the State of Nebraska. This collection is housed in the Harold W. Manter Laboratory of Parasitology (HWML), University of Nebraska State Museum, at the University of Nebraska-Lincoln, and serves as a taxonomic base for our continued efforts to establish a long-term catalog of parasites associated with small mammals in southwestern Nebraska.

["Twenty-seven species of arthropods were collected from 11 species of small mammals (Rodentia, Insectivora), including insects (Phthiraptera, six spp.; Siphonaptera, six spp.) and mites (Metastigmata, two spp.; Mesostigmata, thirteen spp.). Phthiraptera: *Geomydoecus nebrathkensis**, *Hoplopleura acanthopus*, *Hoplopleura onychomydis**, *Hoplopleura hesperomydis*, *Fahrenholzia boleni**, *Fahrenholzia zacatecae**. Siphonaptera: *Orchopeas leucopus*, *Pleochaetis exilis**, *Aetheca wagneri**, *Megabothris asio**, *Foxella ignota*, *Corrodopsylla curvata*. Metastigmata: *Dermacentor variabilis*, *Ixodes sculptus**. Mesostigmata: *Hyperlaelaps microti*, *Androlaelaps circularis**, *Androlaelaps crowei**, *Androlaelaps fahrenheitsi*, *Androlaelaps geomys*, *Echinonyssus geomydis*, *Echinonyssus hilli**, *Echinonyssus incomptis**, *Echinonyssus perognathi**, *Ornithonyssus bacoti**. New state species records (14) are marked with an asterisk. Also, three species of nest-associated macrochelid mites were collected (all new records for Nebraska)."]

Lareschi, M., J. Sanchez & A. Autino. 2016. A review of the fleas (Insecta- Siphonaptera) from Argentina. *Zootaxa* 4103 (3): 239-258.

The Order Siphonaptera comprises cosmopolitan haematophagous ectoparasites of birds and mammals. More than ten years have past [sic, passed] since the last list of species known for Argentina. Herein we provide a review of the fleas from the country, which includes an updated list, host species and geographical distribution for each taxa [sic, taxon], as well as some comments. We report 127 species and subspecies belonging to eleven different families; 42 of these species are endemic. Four genera (*Adoratopsylla*, *Cleopsylla*, *Ctenidiosomus*, and *Nonnapsylla*) and six species and subspecies (*Adoratopsylla* (*Adoratopsylla*) *antiquorum antiquorum*, *Agastopsylla pearsoni*, *Polygenis* (*Polygenis*) *roberti beebei*, *Plocopsylla* (*Plocopsylla*) *silewi*, *Plocopsylla* (*Plocopsylla*) *wilesi* and *Tunga terasma*) are added to the list for Argentina. Nine species new to science are included, described on the bases of specimens collected from Argentina (*Ctenidiosomus austrinus*, *Ectinorus* (*Ectinorus*) *lareschiae*, *Ectinorus* (*Ectinorus*) *spiculatus*, *Ectinorus* (*Ectinorus*) *morenoi*, *Hectopsylla narium*, *Plocopsylla* (*Plocopsylla*) *linardii*, *Neotyphloceras crackensis*, *Neotyphloceras pardinasii* and *Tunga perforans*). Information provided herein contributes to the knowledge of the fleas from Argentina, necessary to a better understanding of their role as parasites themselves and vectors of zoonotic importance.

Morphology and Physiology

Medvedev, S.G. (2015) Morphological diversity of the skeletal structures of fleas (Siphonaptera). Part

1: the general characteristic and features of the head. (2015) Entomological Review, 95 (7), pp. 852-873. DOI: 10.1134/S0013873815070040

[Abstract in Flea News 77]

Medvedev, S. G. (2016). Morphological diversity of the skeletal structures of fleas (Siphonaptera). Part 2: The general characteristic and features of the thorax. Entomological Review, 96(1), 28-50.

Analysis of a considerable amount of data on the anatomy of 27 structures of the thorax in 96 genera of fleas (over 90% of the genera in the world fauna) shows that different flea taxa can be described based on 48 universal and specific characters, whose 203 states reflect the entire known diversity of the flea morphology. Of them, 26 characters with 96 states can be formulated based on universal terms; 22 universal characters with 88 states describe the proportions of the segments and their parts, and also proportions and shapes of their sclerites; 23 specific characters with 107 states describe the structure of the thoracic sclerites and ridges as well as the patterns of their junctions. Judging by the number of characters and their states, the most evolutionarily flexible structures in fleas are the mesosternite and its apodeme together with the upper part of the mesopleural rod. Homoplasies at various levels comprise less than half (40%) of all the character states in the thorax structure. The character states reflecting the phylogenetic closeness of taxa make up about 15%.

Medvedev, S.G. 2015. MORPHOLOGICAL DIVERSITY OF FLEAS' STRUCTURES (SIPHONAPTERA). PART 3: GENERAL CHARACTERISTICS AND FEATURES OF THORACIC SETATION. Parazitologiya 49 (6): 453-464.

The paper continues a series of publications (Medvedev, 2015a, b) devoted to the analysis of flea structural features. In the present publication, structural features of flea thoracic setation are analyzed for the first time. Six characters with 53 states in the structure of the chaetom of the pronotum, meso-, and metathoracic segments are distinguished. The author analyzes the cases of the formation of similar states stipulated by processes of reduction or, by contrast, by strengthening of the chaetom in fleas of separate genera belonging to different superfamilies in relation to the type or peculiarities of parasitism in different flea species. In spite of the presence of strong variability in arrangement and number of thoracic setae, some examples of marking of groups in the range families and superfamilies by certain states of the chaetotaxy of the pronotum and metepimera are revealed.

Ecology and Evolution

Dittmar, K., Zhu, Q., Hastriter, M. W., & Whiting, M. F. (2016). On the probability of dinosaur fleas, and Response, by Taiping Gao, Alexandr P. Rasnitsyn, Chungkun Shih, Xing Xu, Shuo Wang and Dong Ren. BMC Evolutionary Biology, 16(1) doi:10.1186/s12862-015-0568-x

Kreppel, K.S, Telfer, S., Rajerison, M. , Morse, A., Baylis, M. (2016) Effect of temperature and relative humidity on the development times and survival of *Synopsyllus fonquerniei* and *Xenopsylla cheopis*, the flea vectors of plague in Madagascar. Parasites and Vectors, 9 (1), art. no. 1366.

DOI: 10.1186/s13071-016-1366-z

Background: Plague, a zoonosis caused by *Yersinia pestis*, is found in Asia, the Americas but mainly in Africa, with the island of Madagascar reporting almost one third of human cases worldwide. In the highlands of Madagascar, plague is transmitted predominantly by two flea species which coexist on the island, but differ in their distribution. The endemic flea, *Synopsyllus fonquerniei*, dominates flea communities on rats caught outdoors, while the cosmopolitan flea, *Xenopsylla cheopis*, is found mostly on rats caught in houses. Additionally *S. fonquerniei* seems restricted to areas above 800 m. Climatic constraints on the development of the two main vectors of plague could explain the differences in their distribution and the seasonal changes in their abundance. Here we present the first study on effects of temperature and relative humidity on the immature stages of both vector species.

Methods: We examined the two species' temperature and humidity requirements under experimental conditions at five different temperatures and two relative humidities. By employing multivariate and survival analysis we established the impact of temperature and relative humidity on development times and survival for both species. Using degree-day analysis we then predicted the average developmental threshold for larvae to reach pupation and for pupae to complete development under each treatment. This analysis was undertaken separately for the two relative humidities and for the two species.

Results: Development times and time to death differed significantly, with the endemic *S. fonquerniei* taking on average 1.79 times longer to complete development and having a shorter time to death than *X. cheopis* under adverse conditions with high temperature and low humidity. Temperature had a significant effect on the development times of flea larvae and pupae. While humidity did not affect the development times of either species, it did influence the time of death of *S. fonquerniei*. Using degree-day analysis we estimated an average developmental threshold of 9 °C for *S. fonquerniei*, and 12.5 °C for *X. cheopis*.

Conclusions: While many vector-borne diseases are limited to warm, low-lying regions, plague in Madagascar is unusual in being most prevalent in the cool, highland regions of the country. Our results point towards the possibility that this is because the endemic flea vector, *S. fonquerniei*, is better adapted to cool temperatures than the exotic flea vector, *X. cheopis*. Future warming caused by climate change might reduce the area suitable for *S. fonquerniei* and may thus reduce the incidence of plague in Madagascar.

Mazzamuto, M.V., Pisanu, B., Romeo, C., Ferrari, N., Preatoni, D., Wauters, L.A., Chapuis, J.-L., Martinoli, A. (2016) Poor Parasite Community of an Invasive Alien Species: Macroparasites of Pallas's Squirrel in Italy. *Annales Zoologici Fennici*, 53 (1-2), pp. 103-112. DOI: 10.5735/086.053.0209

The aim of the present study was to investigate the macroparasite fauna of Pallas's squirrel, *Callosciurus erythraeus*, native to SE Asia, recently introduced to Italy and co-occurring with the native Eurasian red squirrel *Sciurus vulgaris*. A total of 161 Pallas's squirrels harboured a poor macroparasite fauna, characterized by two main ectoparasite species, the flea *Ceratophyllus (M.) sciurorum sciurorum* (prevalence 50%, mean intensity 1.0 ± 0.1) and the tick *Ixodes ricinus* (prevalence 47%, mean intensity 3.0 ± 0.7), and a few helminths (*Rodentoxyuris sciuri*, *Trichuris muris*, *Strongyloides callosciureus*) all with prevalence below 10%. All parasites, except *S.*

callosciureus, are native to Europe and were acquired in the invaded range. The loss of native parasites might have contributed to their successful invasion. The acquisition of local parasites *C. sciurorum* and *Trichuris sciuri*, and the introduction of the Asiatic nematode *S. callosciureus* may lead to spill-back and spill-over processes towards red squirrels.

Mason, J. M., Randall, T. A., & Frydrychova, R. C. (2016). Telomerase lost? *Chromosoma*, 125(1), 65-73.

Telomerase and telomerase-generated telomeric DNA sequences are widespread throughout eukaryotes, yet they are not universal. Neither telomerase nor the simple DNA repeats associated with telomerase have been found in some plant and animal species. Telomerase was likely lost from Diptera before the divergence of Diptera and Siphonaptera, some 260 million years ago. Even so, Diptera is one of the most successful animal orders, making up 11 % of known animal species. In addition, many species of Coleoptera and Hemiptera seem to lack canonical telomeric repeats at their chromosome ends. These and other insects that appear to lack canonical terminal repeat sequences account for another 10–15 % of animal species. Conversely, the silk moth *Bombyx mori* maintains canonical telomeric sequences at its chromosome ends but seems to lack a functional telomerase. We speculate that a telomere-specific capping complex that recognizes the telomeric repeats and protects chromosome ends is the determining factor in maintaining canonical telomeric sequences and that telomerase is an early and efficacious mechanism for satisfying the needs of capping complex. There are alternate mechanisms for maintaining chromosome ends that do not depend on telomerase, such as recombination found in some human cancer cells and yeast mutants. These mechanisms may maintain the canonical telomeric repeats or allow the terminal sequence to evolve when specificity of the capping complex for terminal repeat sequences is weak.

Zurita, A., Callejón, R., De Rojas, M., Halajian, A., Cutillas, C. (2016) *Ctenocephalides felis* and *Ctenocephalides canis*: Introgressive hybridization? *Systematic Entomology*, 41 (3), pp. 567-579. DOI: 10.1111/syen.12174

In the present work, a comparative molecular study of *Ctenocephalides felis* and *Ctenocephalides canis* isolated from dogs (*Canis lupus familiaris*) from different geographical regions (Spain, Iran and South Africa) was carried out. We found morphological variations in *C. felis* that do not correspond with molecular differences. The Internal Transcribed Spacers 1 and 2 (ITS1, ITS2) and 18S rRNA partial gene, and cytochrome c-oxidase 1 (cox1) mtDNA partial gene sequences were determined to clarify the taxonomic status of these two species, and to assess interpopulation variation and interspecific sequence differences. In addition, a comparative phylogenetic study with other species of fleas using Bayesian, Maximum Parsimony and Maximum Likelihood analysis was performed. The 18S rRNA partial gene fragment was useful neither to discriminate *C. canis* and *C. felis* nor to infer phylogenetic relationships at this level, whereas ITS1 and ITS2 assessed for specific determination in the genus *Ctenocephalides*. The cox1 mtDNA sequences of *C. felis* revealed three main haplotypes and we suggest that there has been introgression of *C. canis* cox1 mtDNA into *C. felis* by *Wolbachia pipientis*. Based on cox1 sequences, restriction mapping identified many endonucleases that could be used to delineate different haplotypes of *C. felis* and to differentiate *C. felis* and *C. canis*.

Pathology and Control

Moemenbellah-Fard, M.D., Shahriari, B., Azizi, K., Fakoorziba, M.R., Mohammadi, J., Amin, M. (2016) Faunal distribution of fleas and their blood-feeding preferences using enzyme-linked

immunosorbent assays from farm animals and human shelters in a new rural region of southern Iran. *Journal of Parasitic Diseases*, 40 (1), pp. 169-175.

DOI: 10.1007/s12639-014-0471-1

Blood sucking insects, such as fleas, are responsible for the transmission of many infectious disease-causing agents which impose an intolerable burden on the health of people living particularly in endemic parts of the world. Fleas (Insecta: Siphonaptera) are found in many parts of the world including Iran. Both adult male and female fleas are obligatory ectoparasites. They are one of the main public health concerns as a result of their nuisance or the potential to act as vectors of a number of medically-important pathogens. The current study was conducted to examine the geographical distribution and fauna of fleas and their anthropophagic index in part of Fars province, southern Iran. This study was the first to be done in Iran. A total of 20 villages were randomly selected. From October 2011 to May 2012, adult fleas were collected by direct hand catch from human to animal shelters. Overall 848 fleas, most of which were blood-fed, were captured from the floor or the body of farm animal hosts (cattle, sheep, goat and hens). Only two different genera of fleas were identified, the main species (99.76 %) was human flea, *Pulex irritans*. The village of Shamsabad was the most heavily infested area. *P. irritans* had an anthropophagic index of 15 % using indirect enzyme-linked immunosorbent assays (ELISA). It could be concluded that *P. irritans* is widely distributed in this area. Based on their blood feeding activity, fleas thus posed a serious health threat to residents and their economically important livestock in this part of Iran.

Schofield, R. (2016) The last visitation of the plague in Sweden: The case of Bräkne-Hoby in 1710-11. *Economic History Review*, 69 (2), pp. 600-626.

DOI: 10.1111/ehr.12097

In an earlier study of the plague in Colyton, Devon, the household distribution of deaths was studied to see whether this provided a method of identifying the causative disease. In this article, a known epidemic of plague in the Swedish parish of Bräkne-Hoby was studied as a means of testing out the generality of the household distribution of deaths. It was discovered that, in this case, the very heavy mortality was due to two radically different means of spreading the disease, initially the classic bubonic one through the rat flea, and latterly, and somewhat surprisingly, the pneumonic one, through the infection of the inhabitants by their own friends and neighbours.

Microbial Symbiotes

Brown, L.D., Banajee, K.H., Foil, L.D., Macaluso, K.R. (2016) Transmission mechanisms of an emerging insect-borne rickettsial pathogen. *Parasites and Vectors*, 9 (1), art. no. 1511.

DOI: 10.1186/s13071-016-1511-8

Background: Vector-borne pathogens must overcome arthropod infection and escape barriers (e.g. midgut and salivary glands) during the extrinsic incubation period (EIP) before subsequent transmission to another host. This particular time span is undetermined for the etiological agent of flea-

borne spotted fever (*Rickettsia felis*). Artificial acquisition of *R. felis* by blood-feeding cat fleas revealed dissemination to the salivary glands after seven days; however, this length of time is inconsistent with co-feeding studies that produced infectious cat fleas within 24 h of infection. In the current study, we demonstrated that an alternative mechanism is responsible for the early-phase transmission that typifies flea-borne *R. felis* spread.

Methods: Co-feeding transmission bioassays were constructed to assess temporal dynamics of *R. felis* amongst cat fleas, including exposure time to produce infectious fleas and association time to transmit infection to naïve fleas. Additional experiments examined the proportion of *R. felis*-exposed cat fleas with contaminated mouthparts, as well as the likelihood for cat fleas to release *R. felis* from their mouthparts following exposure to an infectious bloodmeal. The potential for mechanical transmission of *R. felis* by co-feeding cat fleas was further examined using fluorescent latex beads, as opposed to a live pathogen, which would not require a biological mechanism to achieve transmission.

Results: Analyses revealed that *R. felis*-infected cat fleas were infectious to naïve fleas less than 24 h after exposure to the pathogen, but showed no rickettsial dissemination to the salivary glands during this early-phase transmission. Additionally, the current study revealed that *R. felis*-infected cat fleas must co-feed with naïve fleas for more than 12 h in order for early-phase transmission to occur. Further evidence supported that contaminated flea mouthparts may be the source of the bacteria transmitted early, and demonstrated that *R. felis* is released from the mouthparts during brief probing events. Moreover, the use of fluorescent latex beads supports the notion that early-phase transmission of *R. felis* is a mechanical mechanism.

Conclusions: Determination of the transmission mechanisms utilized by *R. felis* is essential to fully understand the vulnerability of susceptible vertebrate hosts, including humans, to this pathogen.

Carver, S., Bevins, S.N., Lappin, M.R., Boydston, E.E., Lyren, L.M., Alldredge, M., Logan, K.A., Sweanor, L.L., Riley, S.P.D., Serieys, L.E.K., Fisher, R.N., Vickers, T.W., Boyce, W., McBride, R., Cunningham, M.C., Jennings, M., Lewis, J., Lunn, T., Crooks, K.R., Vandewoude, S. (2016) Pathogen exposure varies widely among sympatric populations of wild and domestic felids across the United States. *Ecological Applications*, 26 (2), pp. 367-381.

DOI: 10.1890/15-0445

Understanding how landscape, host, and pathogen traits contribute to disease exposure requires systematic evaluations of pathogens within and among host species and geographic regions. The relative importance of these attributes is critical for management of wildlife and mitigating domestic animal and human disease, particularly given rapid ecological changes, such as urbanization. We screened >1000 samples from sympatric populations of puma (*Puma concolor*), bobcat (*Lynx rufus*), and domestic cat (*Felis catus*) across urban gradients in six sites, representing three regions, in North America for exposure to a representative suite of bacterial, protozoal, and viral pathogens (*Bartonella* sp., *Toxoplasma gondii*, feline herpesvirus-1, feline panleukopenia virus [*sic*], feline calicivirus, and feline immunodeficiency virus). We evaluated prevalence within each species, and examined host trait and land cover determinants of exposure; providing an unprecedented analysis of factors relating to potential for infections in domesticated and wild felids. Prevalence differed among host species (highest for puma and lowest for domestic cat) and was greater for indirectly transmitted pathogens.

Sex was inconsistently predictive of exposure to directly transmitted pathogens only, and age infrequently predictive of both direct and indirectly transmitted pathogens. Determinants of pathogen exposure were widely divergent between the wild felid species. For puma, suburban land use predicted increased exposure to *Bartonella* sp. in southern California, and FHV-1 exposure increased near urban edges in Florida. This may suggest interspecific transmission with domestic cats via flea vectors (California) and direct contact (Florida) around urban boundaries. Bobcats captured near urban areas had increased exposure to *T. gondii* in Florida, suggesting an urban source of prey. Bobcats captured near urban areas in Colorado and Florida had higher FIV exposure, possibly suggesting increased intraspecific interactions through pile-up of home ranges. Beyond these regional and pathogen specific relationships, proximity to the wildland-urban interface did not generally increase the probability of disease exposure in wild or domestic felids, emphasizing the importance of local ecological determinants. Indeed, pathogen exposure was often negatively associated with the wildland-urban interface for all felids. Our analyses suggest cross-species pathogen transmission events around this interface may be infrequent, but followed by self-sustaining propagation within the new host species.

Fleas in Art and History

Excerpt from:

La Terre

(1887)

LES ROUGON-MACQUART HISTOIRE NATURELLE ET SOCIALE D'UNE FAMILLE SOUS LE
SECOND EMPIRE

Par ÉMILE ZOLA (1840, Paris – 1902, Paris)

Le lever et le coucher du jour décidaient du travail: on secouait ses puces dès trois heures du matin, on retournait à la paille vers dix heures du soir. Et il fallait bien qu'elle fût debout la première, pour la soupe de quatre heures, de même qu'elle se couchait la dernière, quand elle avait servi le gros repas de neuf heures, le lard, le boeuf, les choux. Entre ces deux repas, il y en avait trois autres, le pain et le fromage du déjeuner, la seconde soupe de midi, l'émiettée au lait du goûter: en tout, cinq, des repas copieux, arrosés de cidre et de vin, car les moissonneurs, qui travaillent dur, sont exigeants.

Lorsqu'elle fut rentrée et qu'on eut dîné, Buteau, incorrigible, enfonça la main dans son corsage ouvert, pour chercher une puce, qui la piquait, disait-elle. Cela ne la fâchait plus, elle plaisanta même. --Non, non, elle est quelque part où ça te mordrait.

[The Earth

The ROUGON-MACQUART natural and social history of a family in the Second Empire

by ÉMILE ZOLA]

[(Ed. Transl.) The rise and the set of the day decided her work: they shook their fleas at 3 hours in the morning, they returned to the straw around 10 hours at night. And it was necessary that she was the first up, for the soup at 4 hours, the same as when she set the last, when she served the great repast at 9 hours, the bacon, the beef, the cabbage. Between these 2 repasts, there were 3 others, the bread and the cheese of lunch, the second soup of midday, the crumbled milk snack: in all, 5, of copious repasts, washed down with cider and with wine, for the reapers, who worked hard, were exigent.

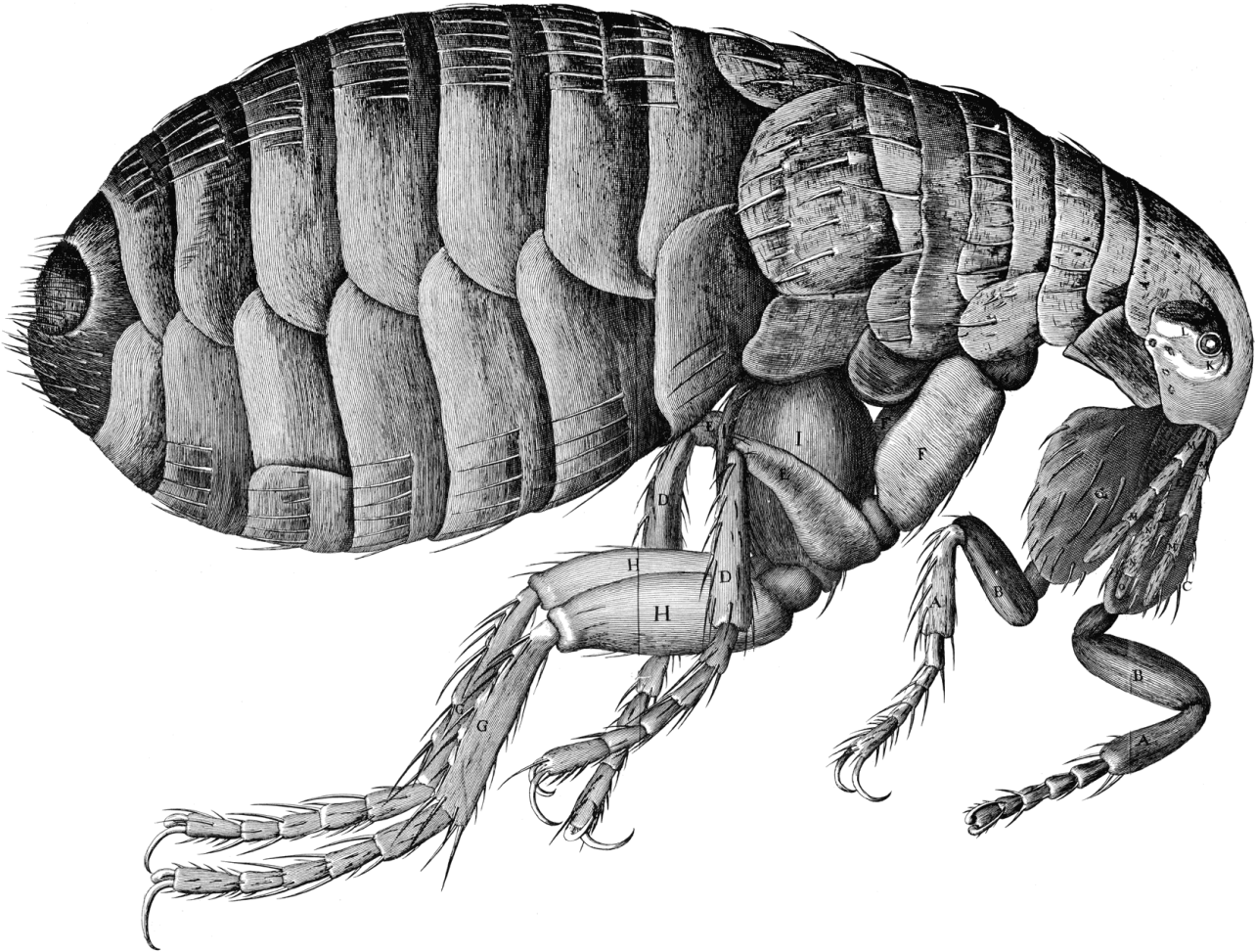
When she returned and they had dined, Buteau, incorrigible, forced his hand into her open blouse, to search for a flea, which bit, she said. This no longer vexed her, she even joked.
--No, no, she is where you will get bitten.]

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(on the next page)

Drawing of a flea. 1665, by Hooke, Robert, (1635, Freshwater, Isle of Wight, England, - 1703, London), printed engraving from *Micrographia: Some Physiological Descriptions of Minute Bodies Made by Magnifying Glasses with Observations and Inquiries Thereupon*. LONDON, Printed by Jo. Martyn, and Ja. Allestry, Printers to the ROYAL SOCIETY, and are to be sold at their Shop at the Bell in S. Paul's Church-yard.

Schem. XXXIII



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